FDE INTERVIEW PREP #04

FDE INTERVIEW PREP · ISSUE 04 OF 08

Frontend questions for FDEs.

React, Next.js, forms, tables and streaming AI responses.

04

AR

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Swipe →

Questions and short answers

01 **Form validation?**

Schema on the client for UX, validate again on the server.

02 **Large tables?**

Server-side paging, sorting and filters, state in the URL.

03 **Server or client component?**

Server for data fetching, client for interaction.

04 **State management?**

Server state in a query cache, little global state.

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Streaming an LLM answer

1. Route returns a stream
2. Client reads chunks
3. Append tokens to state
4. Stop button aborts
5. Save when complete

> Server-sent events or a ReadableStream both work. Handle the broken stream case.

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Operator UI

DEMO UI

- Chat box only
- Spinner for 20 seconds
- No sources
- Errors in the console

OPERATOR UI

- Fits their workflow screen
- Streams, can be stopped
- Shows sources to check
- Clear errors and retry

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How to answer

DO

- ✓ Start from the operator's task
- ✓ Mention loading and error states
- ✓ Keyboard and accessibility
- ✓ Validate on the server too

AVOID

- ✗ Trust client validation
- ✗ Load 50,000 rows
- ✗ Hide AI sources
- ✗ Block the UI while waiting

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Practise these

- [x] Form with schema validation
- [x] Paginated, filterable table
- [x] Streaming chat with stop
- [x] Error and empty states
- [x] Next.js route handler

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KEY TAKEAWAY

Build for the operator's workflow, not for the demo.

→ Validate twice: client and server

→ Page large tables on the server

→ Stream, allow stop, show sources

YOUR TURN

What makes an internal AI tool feel trustworthy to operators?

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Next in the series: #05 Data engineering questions for FDEs

Save · Repost

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